Grade 8 practice paper 1

Time allowed: 3 hours · 100 marks · pass 66, merit 80, distinction 90

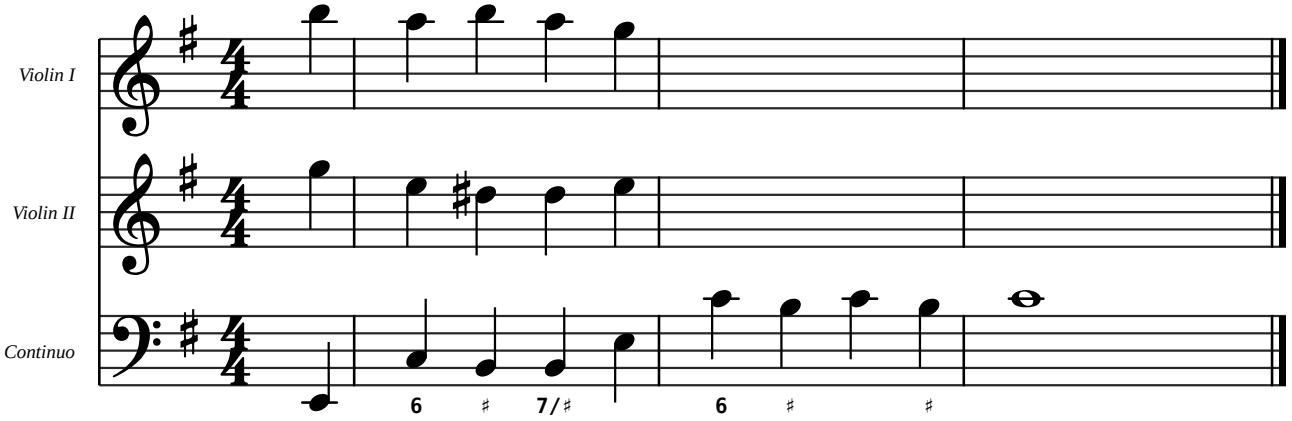
Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 100

Our own paper in the style of the ABRSM Grade 8 exam, not an ABRSM paper. Answer every question. Suggested timing: questions 1 and 2, 25 minutes each; question 3, 35 minutes; questions 4 and 5, 35 minutes each; 25 minutes to check.

Question 1: A trio sonata (15 marks)

15 marks

1. Continue the two violin parts of this trio sonata (E minor) to the end, following the figured bass. Keep the parts independent and write a cadence at the end.



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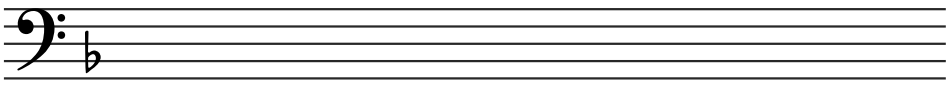
Question 2: Completing a keyboard piece (15 marks)

15 marks

2. Complete this keyboard outline (D minor). Bar 1 is complete; in the other bars the melody and bass are given. Continue the left-hand broken chord to the end, fitting each chord.



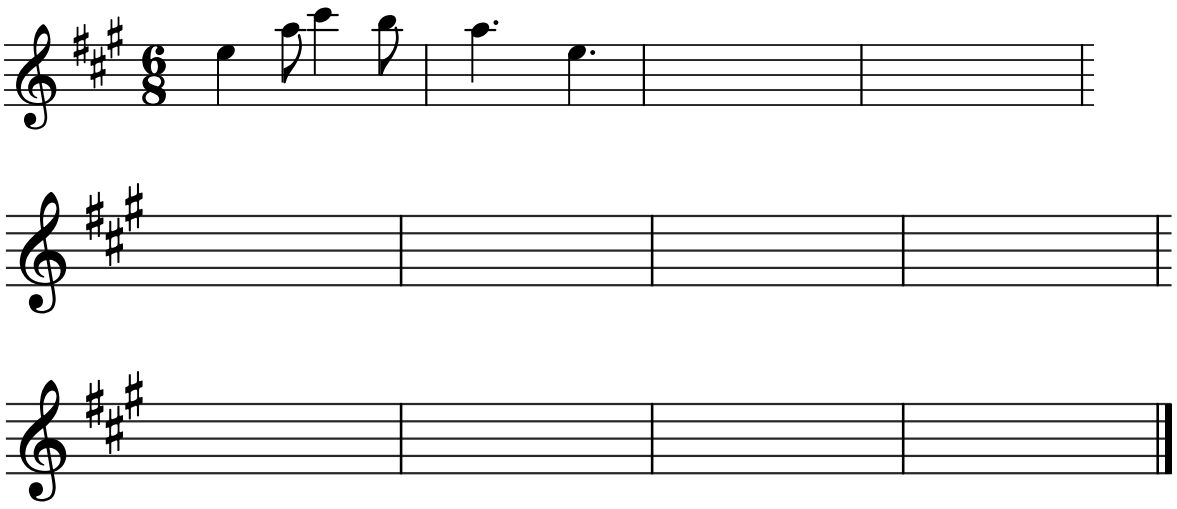
Pattern: broken chord. Write the left hand in the empty bars.



Question 3: Composition (20 marks)

20 marks

3. Composition: continue this opening for oboe (A major) to make a melody of at least 12 bars. Modulate to a related key and come back, and add performance directions.



Oboe range: B♭3 to about F6. Add tempo, dynamics, phrasing and articulation.

Question 4: A chamber score (25 marks)

3 marks

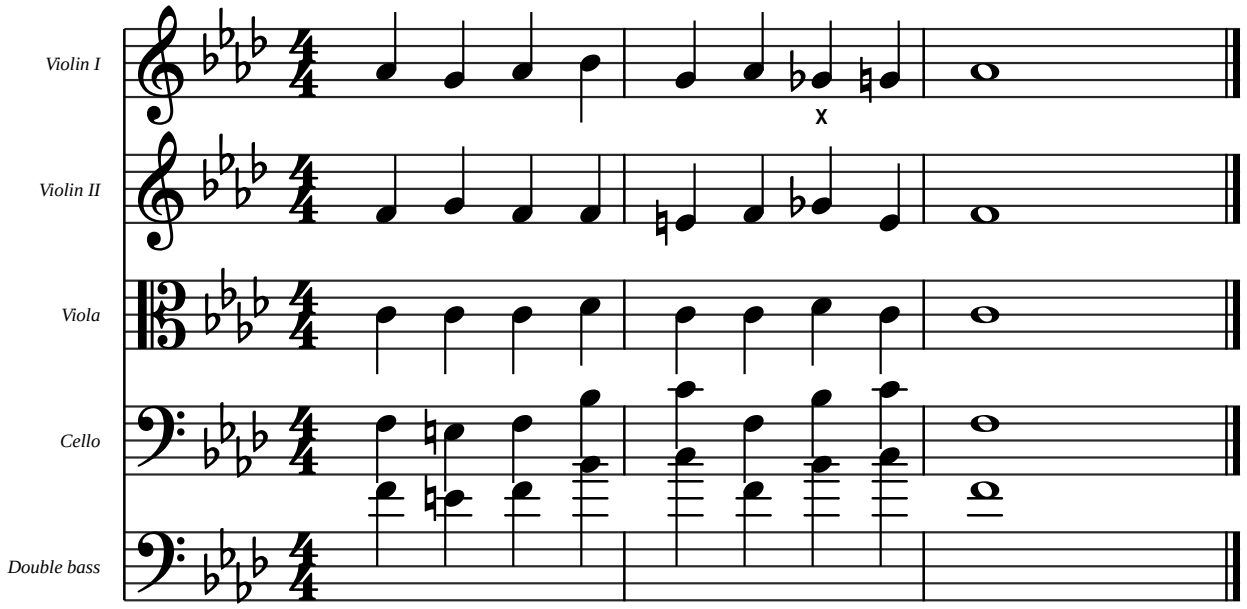
4. At X (Fr6 in F♯ minor), which instrument plays the sharpened 4th?



A. Viola B. Violin I C. Double bass D. Cello

3 marks

5. This piano quintet sounds in F minor. Name the chord at X.



A. N6 B. IV7d C. V D. IV7

3 marks

6. Name the interval between the SOUNDING notes at X (violin I) and Y (cello).



A. compound major 6th B. compound perfect 6th C. compound augmented 6th D. compound minor 6th

3 marks

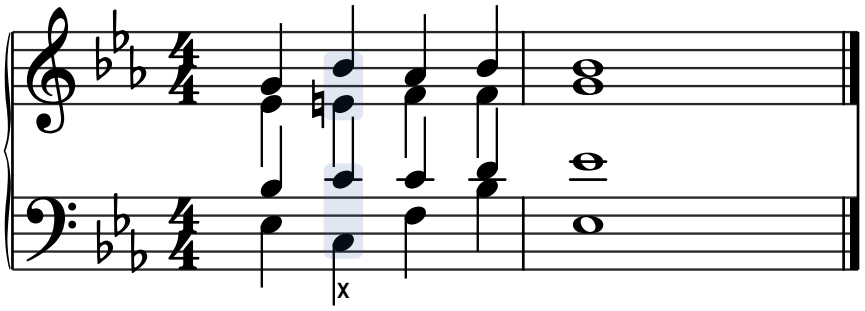
7. Which cadence ends this extract for string quartet? (A major)



A. interrupted B. plagal C. imperfect D. perfect

3 marks

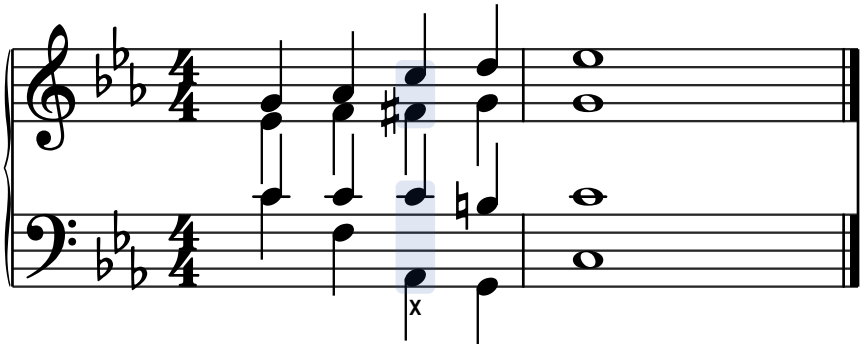
8. This passage is in E♭ major. Name the chord marked X.



A. V7/V B. II7d C. I7d D. V7/II

3 marks

9. This passage is in C minor. Name the chord marked X.



A. VI7 B. It6 C. II7c D. IIb

3 marks

10. What does this mean?

stringendo

A. marked, accented (German) B. mysteriously C. getting livelier (French) D. pressing on, getting faster

4 marks

11. Which cadence ends this extract for wind quintet? (G major)



A. imperfect B. perfect C. interrupted D. plagal

Question 5: An orchestral score (25 marks)

3 marks

12. This extract sounds in B♭ major. Name the chord at X.



A. II7b

B. V7/VI

C. V7/II

D. VII7b

3 marks

13. The clarinet in A plays the written note at X. Which note actually sounds?



A. C

B. F

C. E

D. G

3 marks

14. The trumpet in D plays the written note at X. Which note actually sounds?



A. F♯ B. B C. C D. D

3 marks

15. How many of these staves are for transposing instruments that do NOT sound at the written pitch or an octave away?



A. 6 B. 2 C. 3 D. 4

3 marks

16. This passage is in A major. Name the chord marked X.



A. V7/II B. VII7c C. Ib D. V7/V

3 marks

17. What does this mean?

mezza voce

A. at half voice, restrained B. getting livelier (French) C. let it vibrate (don't damp the sound) D. very (German)

3 marks

18. What does this mean?

lontano

A. bow over the fingerboard (French) B. marked, accented (German) C. distant D. bow near the bridge

4 marks

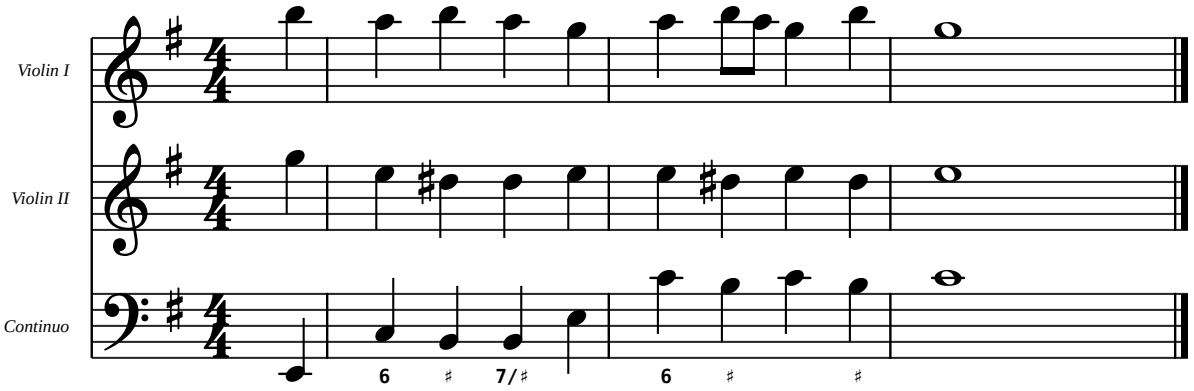
19. The clarinet in A plays the written note at X. Which note actually sounds?



A. F B. A C. E D. G

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

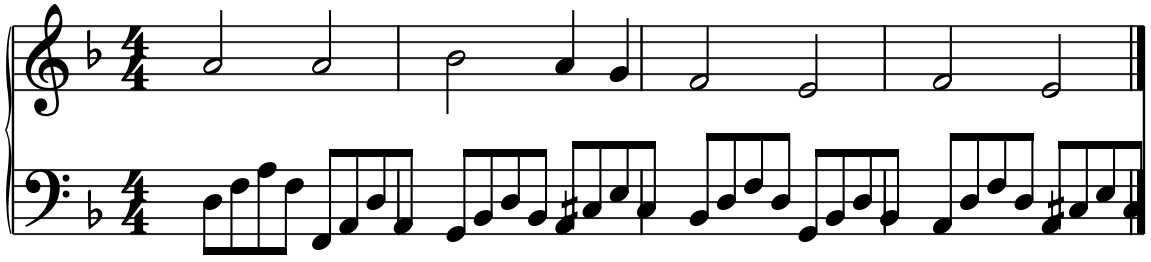
1. Q1 · 15m **Mark with the checklist; one model answer below**.



    1. Every chord follows the figures, with the 3rd present
    2. No consecutive 5ths or octaves between any two parts (including the bass)
    3. The two violins are independent: contrary or oblique motion, some imitation or sequence
    4. Leading notes rise, 7ths fall, suspensions are prepared and resolve down
    5. The violins stay mostly within an octave of each other (they may cross)
    6. Some quaver movement for life; a clear cadence at the end

    Marking: start from 15. Take off 2 for each wrong chord, missing 3rd or consecutive; 1 for a weak part (no movement, too far apart). Other good answers earn full marks.

2. Q2 · 15m **Mark with the checklist; one model answer below**.



    Chords: I – Ib – II7b – V – VI – II7b – Ic – V

    1. The pattern from bar 1 is kept exactly in shape and rhythm
    2. Every bar fits the harmony implied by the melody and bass
    3. Chromatic notes (secondary dominants, augmented 6ths) are spelled correctly
    4. No consecutive octaves or 5ths between the melody and the bass
    5. The cadence is clear, ending on a full tonic chord
    6. The texture suits the piano: comfortable for the hands

    Marking: start from 15. Take off 1–2 for each bar with a wrong chord or a broken pattern, and 2 for each consecutive.

3. Q3 · 20m **Mark with the checklist; one model answer below**.



   1. Bars 1–4: the lilting opening, a sequence a step higher, and a pause on E over the dominant.
   2. Bars 5–8: D♯ takes the music to E major (the dominant), cadencing in bar 8.
   3. Bars 9–12: D♮ returns to A major; the melody winds down to the tonic.

   Checklist:

   1. At least 12 bars, every bar the right length
   2. Clear phrases (often 4 + 4 + 4) with cadences at the ends
   3. The opening idea comes back, varied or developed (sequence, inversion, new rhythm)
   4. A modulation to a related key with the right accidental, then a clear return
   5. One high point, a good balance of steps and leaps, a strong ending on the tonic
   6. Written for the instrument: range, breathing or bowing, idiomatic figures
   7. Tempo, dynamics with changes, phrasing and articulation
4. Q4 · 3m **A: Viola**. Viola has B♯: the sharpened 4th (it rises a semitone to the dominant).
5. Q4 · 3m **A: N6**. Sounding notes at X: B♭, D♭, G♭: G♭–B♭–D♭, so N6.
6. Q4 · 3m **D: compound minor 6th**. The violin I sounds B♭4; the cello sounds D3. That's 13 letter names apart: a compound minor 6th.
7. Q4 · 3m **D: perfect**. The last two chords are V–I: a perfect cadence.
8. Q4 · 3m **D: V7/II**. X is C–E–G–B♭: V7/II, a secondary dominant (dominant 7th of II). It is V7 of the key of II, so its leading note (E) rises to the root of II.
9. Q4 · 3m **B: It6**. X is A♭–C–F♯: It6, an Italian augmented 6th. Its augmented 6th (between the bass and the ♯4) opens out to the octave on the dominant.
10. Q4 · 3m **D: pressing on, getting faster**. stringendo means "pressing on, getting faster".
11. Q4 · 4m **B: perfect**. The last two chords are V–I: a perfect cadence.
12. Q5 · 3m **C: V7/II**. Read the strings (they don't transpose): G, D, F, B: G–B–D–F, so V7/II, a secondary dominant (dominant 7th of II).
13. Q5 · 3m **C: E**. The clarinet in A sounds a minor 3rd lower than written: written G sounds as E.
14. Q5 · 3m **D: D**. The trumpet in D sounds a major 2nd higher than written: written C sounds as D.
15. Q5 · 3m **D: 4**. Cor anglais, clarinet in A, horn in E♭ and trumpet in D. (The piccolo and double bass only transpose by an octave.)

16. Q5 · 3m **A: V7/II**. X is F♯–A♯–C♯–E: V7/II, a secondary dominant (dominant 7th of II). It is V7 of the key of II, so its leading note (A♯) rises to the root of II.
17. Q5 · 3m **A: at half voice, restrained**. mezza voce means "at half voice, restrained".
18. Q5 · 3m **C: distant**. lontano means "distant".
19. Q5 · 4m **D: G**. The clarinet in A sounds a minor 3rd lower than written: written B♭ sounds as G.

Grade 8 practice paper 2

Time allowed: 3 hours · 100 marks · pass 66, merit 80, distinction 90

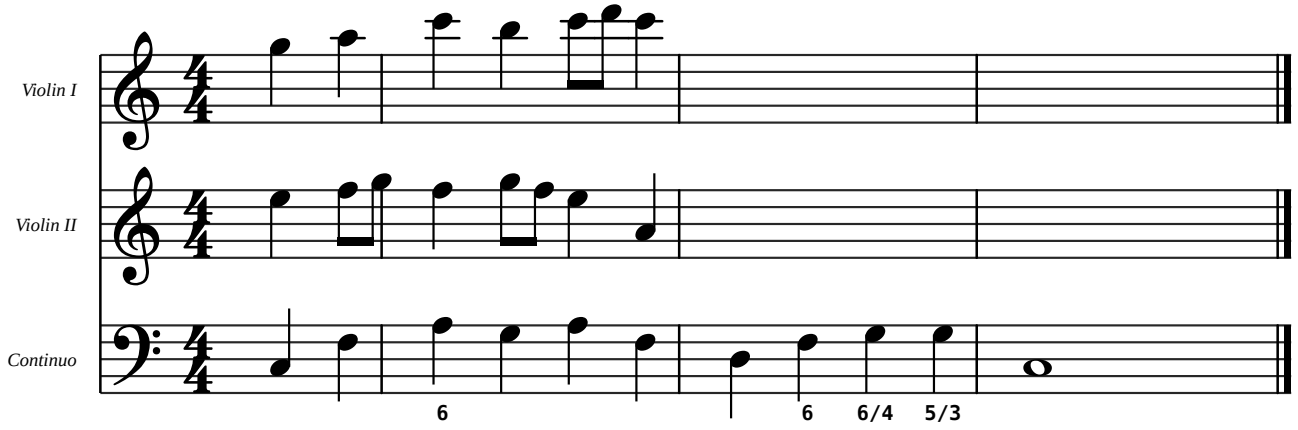
Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 100

Our own paper in the style of the ABRSM Grade 8 exam, not an ABRSM paper. Answer every question. Suggested timing: questions 1 and 2, 25 minutes each; question 3, 35 minutes; questions 4 and 5, 35 minutes each; 25 minutes to check.

Question 1: A trio sonata (15 marks)

15 marks

1. Continue the two violin parts of this trio sonata (C major) to the end, following the figured bass. Keep the parts independent and write a cadence at the end.

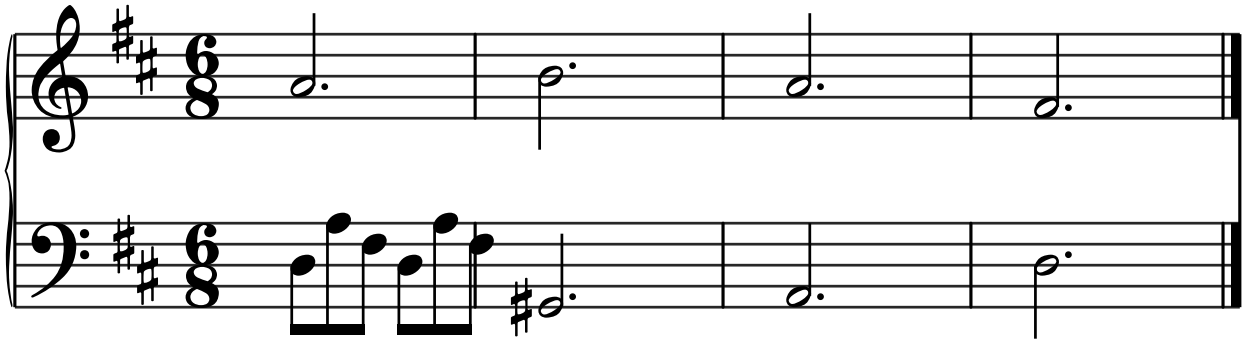


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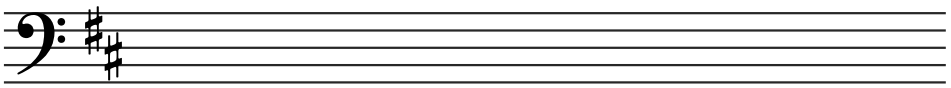
Question 2: Completing a keyboard piece (15 marks)

15 marks

2. Complete this keyboard outline (D major). Bar 1 is complete; in the other bars the melody and bass are given. Continue the left-hand rocking quavers to the end, fitting each chord.



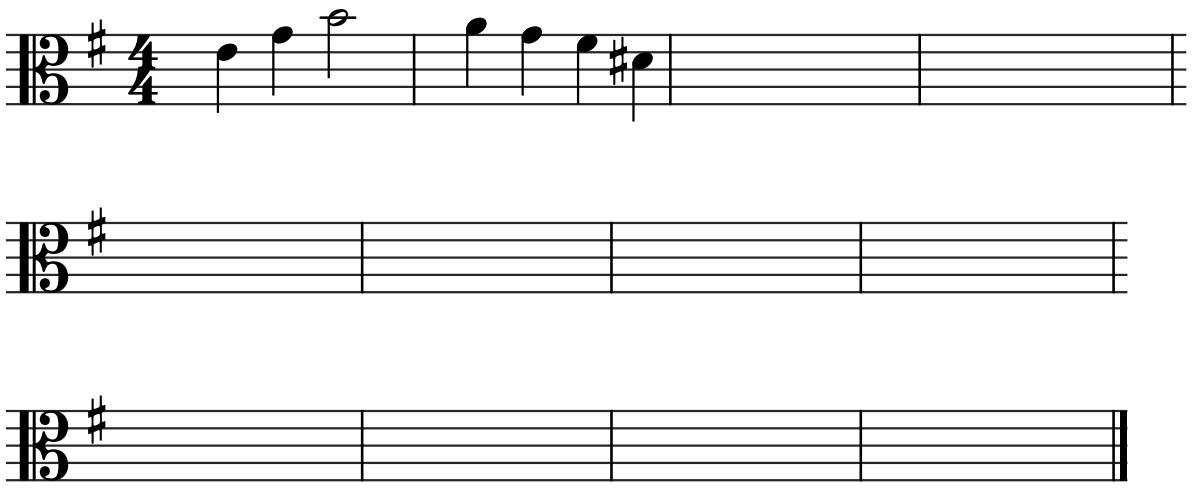
Pattern: rocking quavers. Write the left hand in the empty bars.



Question 3: Composition (20 marks)

20 marks

3. Composition: continue this opening for viola (E minor) to make a melody of at least 12 bars. Modulate to a related key and come back, and add performance directions.



Viola range: C3 upwards (comfortably up to about E5). Add tempo, dynamics, phrasing and articulation.

Question 4: A chamber score **(25 marks)**

3 marks

4. This wind quintet sounds in F major. Name the chord at X.



A. IVb B. IVc C. VI D. V7d/V

3 marks

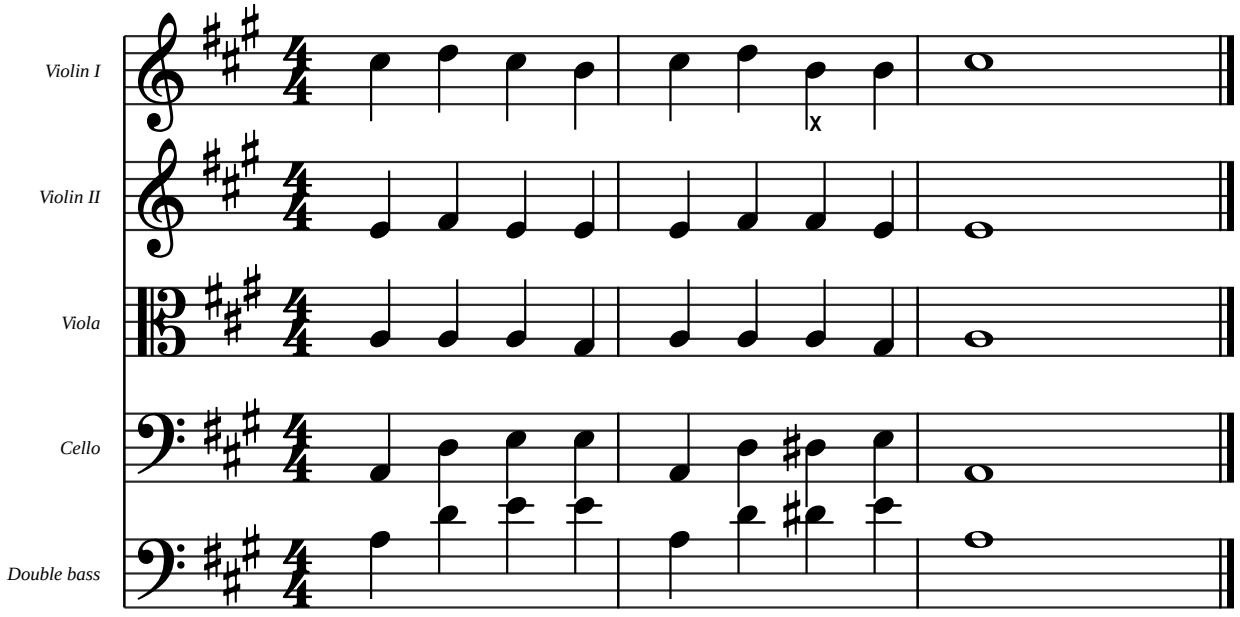
5. At X (V7/IV in F major), which instrument plays the leading note of the new key?



A. Double bass B. Violin I C. Viola D. Violin II

3 marks

6. At X (V7b/V in A major), which instrument plays the 7th?



A. Cello B. Viola C. Violin I D. Double bass

3 marks

7. At X (V7/II in A major), which instrument plays the leading note of the new key?



A. Flute B. Horn in F C. Bassoon D. Oboe

3 marks

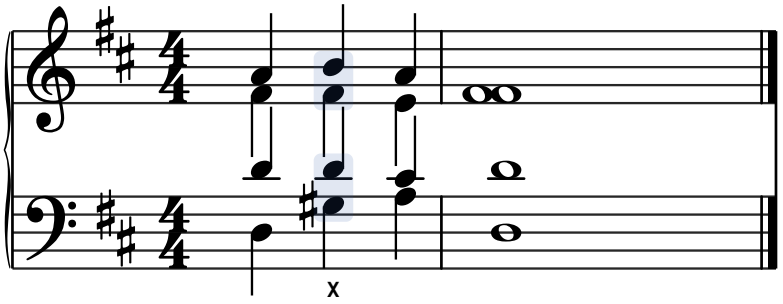
8. This passage is in A major. What kind of chord is X?



A. a secondary dominant (dominant 7th of II) B. a French augmented 6th C. a German augmented 6th D. a secondary dominant (dominant 7th of V)

3 marks

9. This passage is in D major. Name the chord marked X.



A. V7d B. IIb C. I7 D. VII7/V

3 marks

10. Which term means "at the same speed (the beat stays the same)"?

A. l'istesso tempo B. sur la touche C. en dehors D. a 2

4 marks

11. This string quartet is in E minor. What kind of chord is heard at X?



A. a dominant 7th B. an Italian augmented 6th C. a French augmented 6th D. a Neapolitan 6th

Question 5: An orchestral score (25 marks)

3 marks

12. The horn in E♭ plays the written note at X. Which note actually sounds?



A. C

B. D

C. B

D. E

3 marks

13. The cor anglais plays the written note at X. Which note actually sounds?



A. E

B. D

C. C

D. F

3 marks

14. How many of these staves are for transposing instruments that do NOT sound at the written pitch or an octave away?



A. 4 B. 6 C. 3 D. 2

3 marks

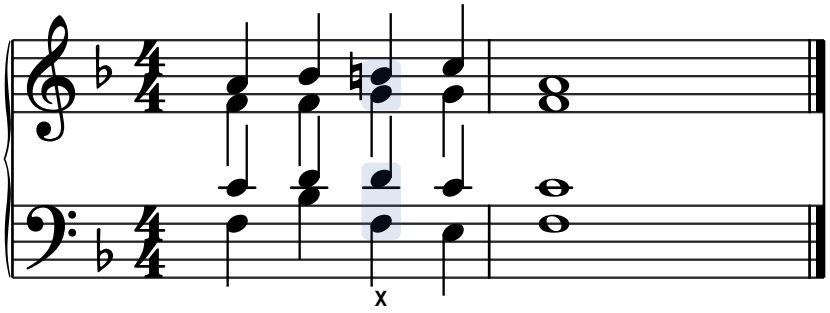
15. The clarinet in A plays the written note at X. Which note actually sounds?



A. D B. F C. A D. A♭

3 marks

16. This passage is in F major. What kind of chord is X?



A. a diminished 7th B. a German augmented 6th C. a French augmented 6th D. a secondary dominant (dominant 7th of V)

3 marks

17. What does this mean?

piangevole

A. the main part: bring it out (German)
B. lively (German)
C. brought out, prominent (French)
D. plaintive, tearful

3 marks

18. What does this mean?

smorzando (smorz.)

A. plaintive, tearful
B. dying away
C. flutter-tonguing (German)
D. sustained

4 marks

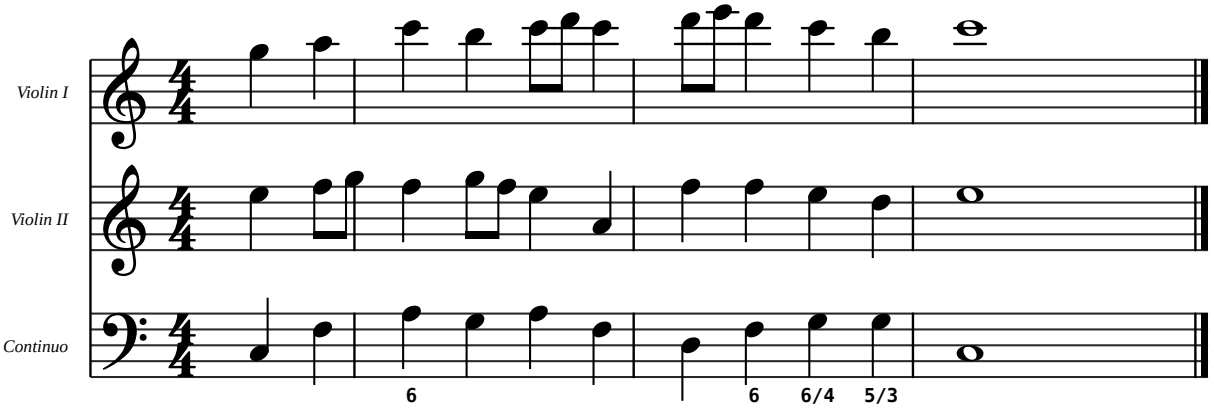
19. This extract sounds in G major. Name the chord at X.



A. I7c
B. V7b/V
C. V7
D. VI

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

1. Q1 · 15m **Mark with the checklist; one model answer below**.



1. Every chord follows the figures, with the 3rd present
2. No consecutive 5ths or octaves between any two parts (including the bass)
3. The two violins are independent: contrary or oblique motion, some imitation or sequence
4. Leading notes rise, 7ths fall, suspensions are prepared and resolve down
5. The violins stay mostly within an octave of each other (they may cross)
6. Some quaver movement for life; a clear cadence at the end

Marking: start from 15. Take off 2 for each wrong chord, missing 3rd or consecutive; 1 for a weak part (no movement, too far apart). Other good answers earn full marks.

2. Q2 · 15m **Mark with the checklist; one model answer below**.



Chords: I – VII7/V – V – I

1. The pattern from bar 1 is kept exactly in shape and rhythm
2. Every bar fits the harmony implied by the melody and bass
3. Chromatic notes (secondary dominants, augmented 6ths) are spelled correctly
4. No consecutive octaves or 5ths between the melody and the bass
5. The cadence is clear, ending on a full tonic chord
6. The texture suits the piano: comfortable for the hands

Marking: start from 15. Take off 1–2 for each bar with a wrong chord or a broken pattern, and 2 for each consecutive.

3. Q3 · 20m **Mark with the checklist; one model answer below**.

Adagio



1. Bars 1–4: the opening and a rise to B over the dominant (an imperfect cadence).
2. Bars 5–8: D♮ instead of D♯ points to G major, the relative major, with a cadence on G in bar 7.
3. Bars 9–12: D♯ returns; the last phrase climbs to C, then the leading note rises to E.

Checklist:

1. At least 12 bars, every bar the right length
2. Clear phrases (often 4 + 4 + 4) with cadences at the ends
3. The opening idea comes back, varied or developed (sequence, inversion, new rhythm)
4. A modulation to a related key with the right accidental, then a clear return
5. One high point, a good balance of steps and leaps, a strong ending on the tonic
6. Written for the instrument: range, breathing or bowing, idiomatic figures
7. Tempo, dynamics with changes, phrasing and articulation

4. Q4 · 3m **D: V7d/V**. Sounding notes at X: F, D, G, B: G–B–D–F, so V7d/V, a secondary dominant (dominant 7th of V).
5. Q4 · 3m **B: Violin I**. Violin I has A: the leading note of the new key (it rises a semitone).
6. Q4 · 3m **B: Viola**. Viola has A: the 7th (it falls by step).
7. Q4 · 3m **A: Flute**. Flute has A♯: the leading note of the new key (it rises a semitone).
8. Q4 · 3m **A: a secondary dominant (dominant 7th of II)**. X is F♯–A♯–C♯–E (V7/II): a secondary dominant (dominant 7th of II).
9. Q4 · 3m **D: VII7/V**. X is G♯–B–D–F♯: VII7/V, a secondary dominant (dominant 7th of V). It is V7 of the key of V, so its leading note (G♯) rises to the root of V.
10. Q4 · 3m **A: l'istesso tempo**. l'istesso tempo means "at the same speed (the beat stays the same)".
11. Q4 · 4m **C: a French augmented 6th**. At X the notes are C–E–F♯–A♯: a French augmented 6th.
12. Q5 · 3m **B: D**. The horn in E♭ sounds a major 6th lower than written: written B sounds as D.
13. Q5 · 3m **D: F**. The cor anglais sounds a perfect 5th lower than written: written C sounds as F.
14. Q5 · 3m **A: 4**. Cor anglais, clarinet in A, horn in E♭ and trumpet in D. (The piccolo and double bass only transpose by an octave.)
15. Q5 · 3m **B: F**. The clarinet in A sounds a minor 3rd lower than written: written A♭ sounds as F.

16. Q5 · 3m **D: a secondary dominant (dominant 7th of V)**. X is G–B–D–F (V7d/V): a secondary dominant (dominant 7th of V).
17. Q5 · 3m **D: plaintive, tearful**. piangevole means "plaintive, tearful".
18. Q5 · 3m **B: dying away**. smorzando (smorz.) means "dying away".
19. Q5 · 4m **C: V7**. Read the strings (they don't transpose): D, A, C, F♯: D–F♯–A–C, so V7.

Grade 8 practice paper 3

Time allowed: 3 hours · 100 marks · pass 66, merit 80, distinction 90

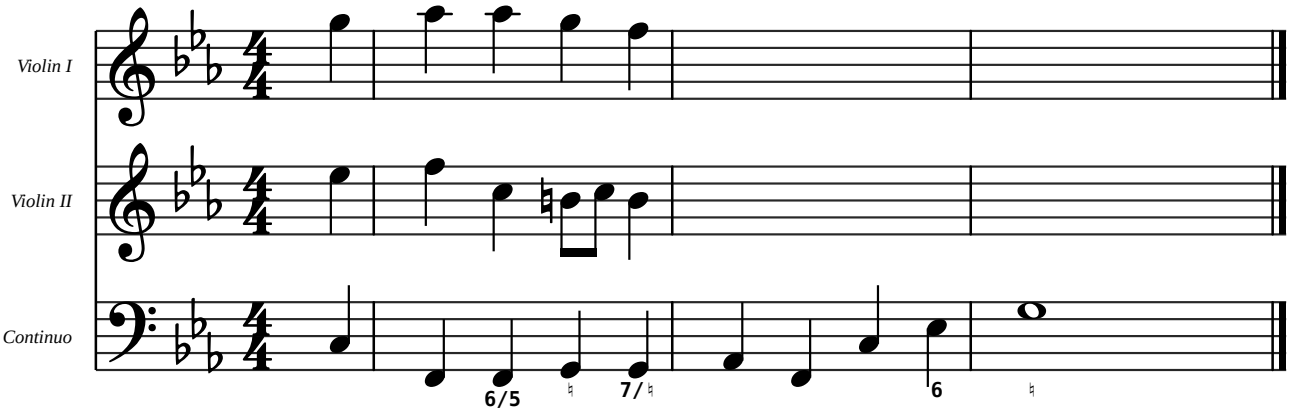
Name _____ Date _____ Score ____ / 100

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Question 1: A trio sonata (15 marks)

15 marks

1. Continue the two violin parts of this trio sonata (C minor) to the end, following the figured bass. Keep the parts independent and write a cadence at the end.



Copy onto manuscript paper, or write straight onto the staves above.

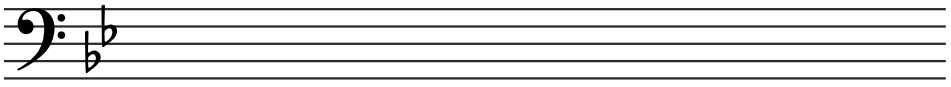
Question 2: Completing a keyboard piece (15 marks)

15 marks

2. Complete this keyboard outline (G minor). Bar 1 is complete; in the other bars the melody and bass are given. Continue the left-hand waltz bass to the end, fitting each chord.



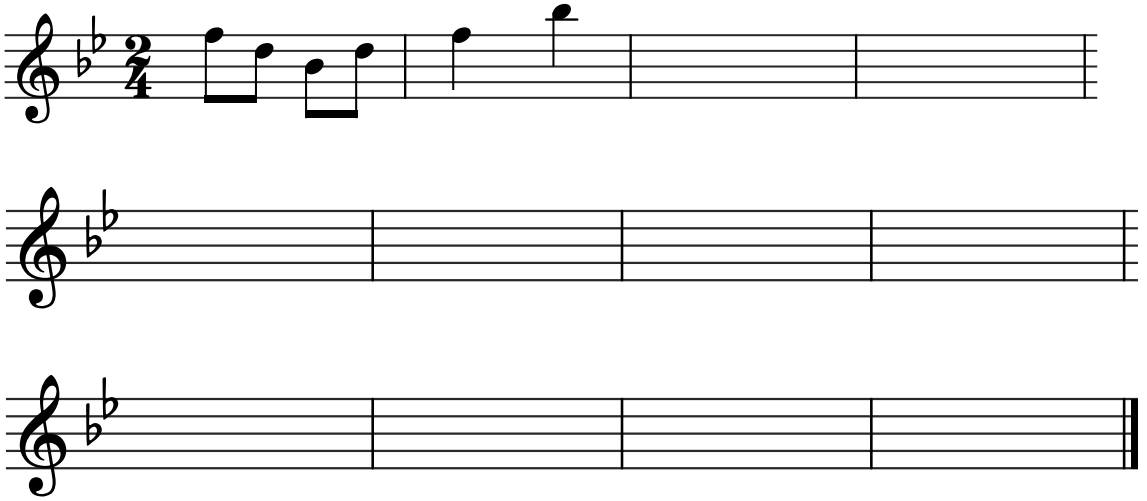
Pattern: waltz bass. Write the left hand in the empty bars.



Question 3: Composition (20 marks)

20 marks

3. Composition: continue this opening for violin (B♭ major) to make a melody of at least 12 bars. Modulate to a related key and come back, and add performance directions.



Violin range: G3 upwards (comfortably up to about E6). Add tempo, dynamics, phrasing and articulation.

Question 4: A chamber score (25 marks)

3 marks

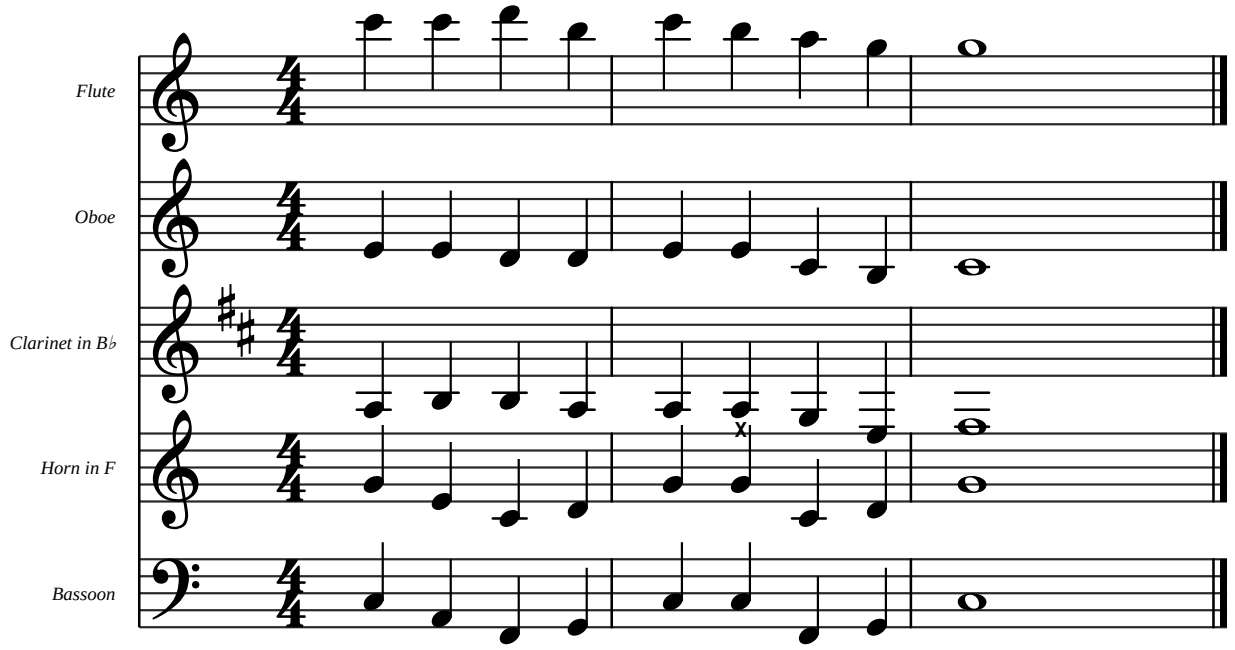
4. This wind quintet sounds in F minor. Name the chord at X.



A. V7/IV B. V7/VI C. V7d D. VII7d

3 marks

5. The clarinet in B♭ plays the written note at X. Which note actually sounds?



A. A B. B C. G D. F

3 marks

6. At X (V7b/V in G major), which instrument plays the 7th?



A. Oboe B. Bassoon C. Horn in F D. Flute

3 marks

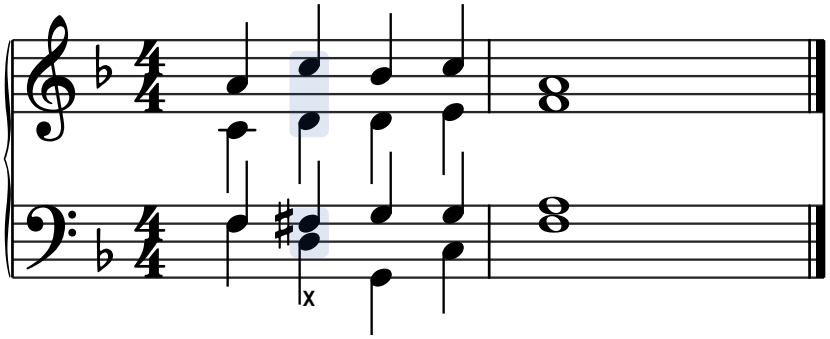
7. Name the viola's note at X, with its octave (middle C is C4).



A. E4 B. D♯4 C. F4 D. C4

3 marks

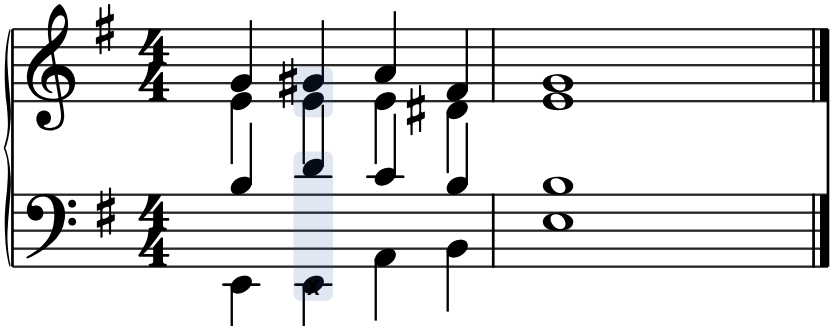
8. This passage is in F major. What kind of chord is X?



A. a German augmented 6th B. a secondary dominant (dominant 7th of IV) C. a secondary dominant (dominant 7th of II) D. a French augmented 6th

3 marks

9. This passage is in E minor. Name the chord marked X.



A. VII7 B. V7/IV C. V7/V D. V7

3 marks

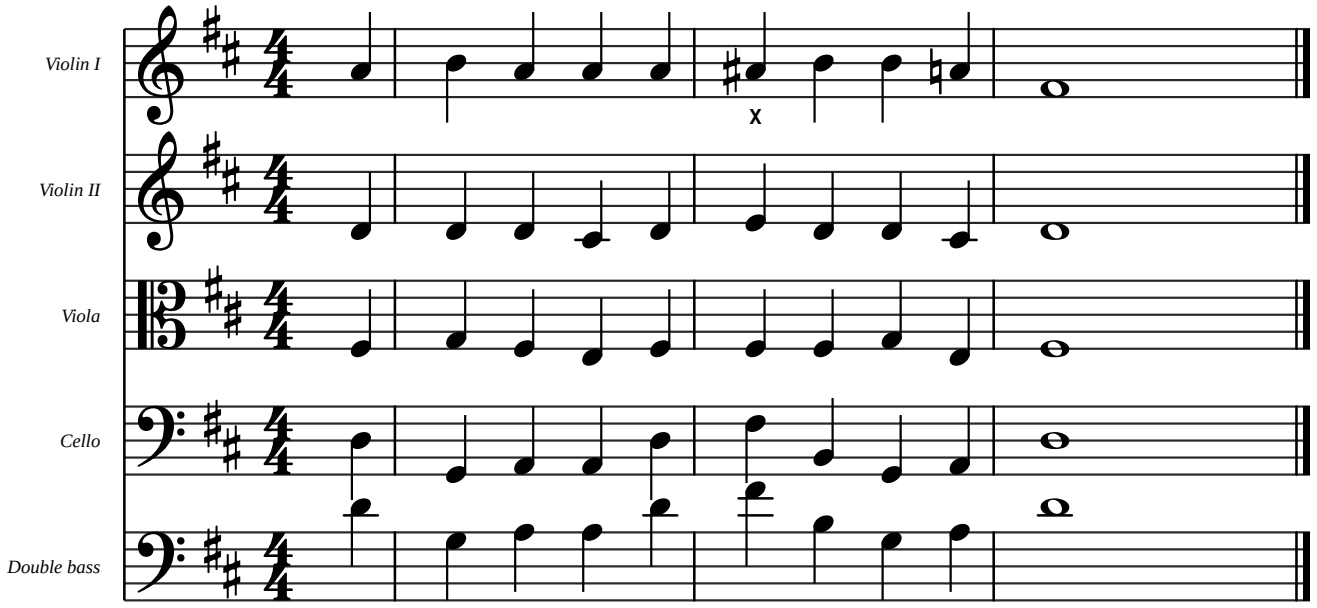
10. What does this mean?

tempo rubato

A. freely, at the performer's pleasure B. flutter-tonguing (German) C. with some freedom of time D. distant

4 marks

11. This piano quintet sounds in D major. Name the chord at X.



A. VIIb B. V7d/V C. Ib D. V7/VI

Question 5: An orchestral score (25 marks)

3 marks

12. The horn in E♭ plays the written note at X. Which note actually sounds?



A. C

B. B

C. A

D. D

3 marks

13. The cor anglais plays the written note at X. Which note actually sounds?



A. G

B. B

C. E

D. C

3 marks

14. This extract sounds in D major. Name the chord at X.



A. IV7 B. V7d/V C. It6 D. VIIb

3 marks

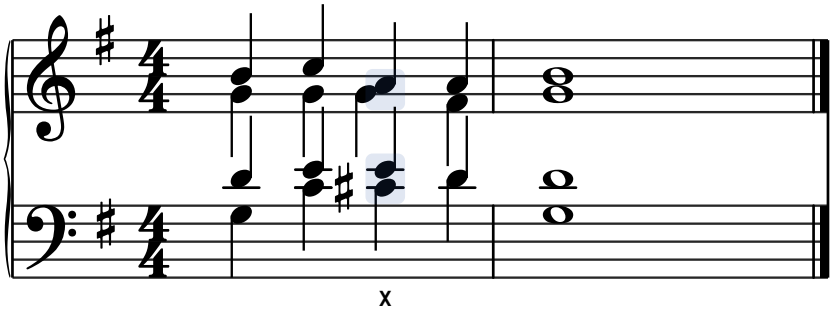
15. The trumpet in D plays the written note at X. Which note actually sounds?



A. D B. C C. A D. B

3 marks

16. This passage is in G major. Name the chord marked X.



A. VIIb B. V C. V7b/V D. IV

3 marks

17. What does this mean?

sur la touche

A. with some freedom of time B. hesitating, slowing (German) C. heavily D. bow over the fingerboard (French)

3 marks

18. Which term means "at the same speed (the beat stays the same)"?

A. misterioso B. kräftig C. l'istesso tempo D. au mouvement

4 marks

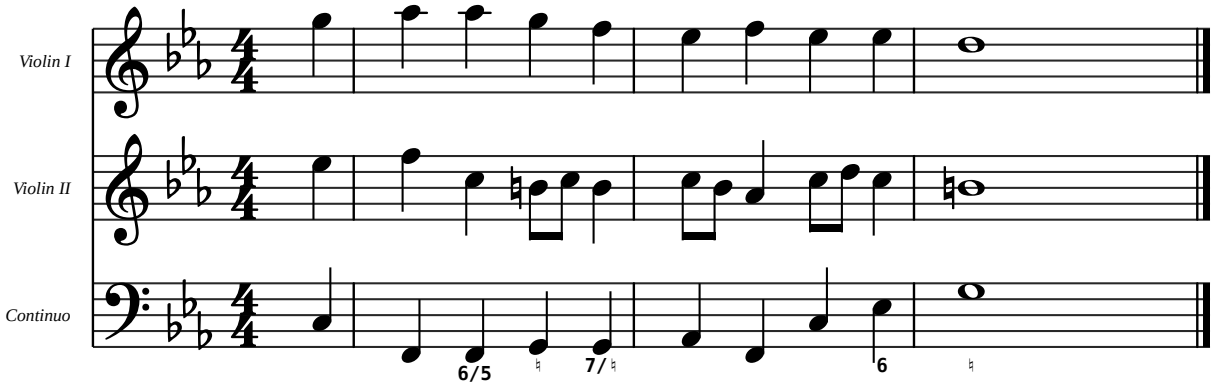
19. The clarinet in A plays the written note at X. Which note actually sounds?



A. G B. D C. A D. F

MARKING KEY (FOR MUM)

1. Q1 · 15m **Mark with the checklist; one model answer below**.



   1. Every chord follows the figures, with the 3rd present
   2. No consecutive 5ths or octaves between any two parts (including the bass)
   3. The two violins are independent: contrary or oblique motion, some imitation or sequence
   4. Leading notes rise, 7ths fall, suspensions are prepared and resolve down
   5. The violins stay mostly within an octave of each other (they may cross)
   6. Some quaver movement for life; a clear cadence at the end

   Marking: start from 15. Take off 2 for each wrong chord, missing 3rd or consecutive; 1 for a weak part (no movement, too far apart). Other good answers earn full marks.

2. Q2 · 15m **Mark with the checklist; one model answer below**.



   Chords: I – IVb – V – I

   1. The pattern from bar 1 is kept exactly in shape and rhythm
   2. Every bar fits the harmony implied by the melody and bass
   3. Chromatic notes (secondary dominants, augmented 6ths) are spelled correctly
   4. No consecutive octaves or 5ths between the melody and the bass
   5. The cadence is clear, ending on a full tonic chord
   6. The texture suits the piano: comfortable for the hands

   Marking: start from 15. Take off 1–2 for each bar with a wrong chord or a broken pattern, and 2 for each consecutive.

3. Q3 · 20m **Mark with the checklist; one model answer below**.



   1. Bars 1–4: the lively opening and a scale falling to C (an imperfect cadence).
   2. Bars 5–8: E♮ takes the music to F major, the dominant, cadencing on F in bar 8.
   3. Bars 9–12: E♭ returns; the last phrase ends with A, the leading note, rising to B♭.

   Checklist:

   1. At least 12 bars, every bar the right length
   2. Clear phrases (often 4 + 4 + 4) with cadences at the ends
   3. The opening idea comes back, varied or developed (sequence, inversion, new rhythm)
   4. A modulation to a related key with the right accidental, then a clear return
   5. One high point, a good balance of steps and leaps, a strong ending on the tonic
   6. Written for the instrument: range, breathing or bowing, idiomatic figures
   7. Tempo, dynamics with changes, phrasing and articulation
4. Q4 · 3m **D: VII7d**. Sounding notes at X: D♭, B♭, E, G: E–G–B♭–D♭, so VII7d.
5. Q4 · 3m **C: G**. The clarinet in B♭ sounds a major 2nd lower than written: written A sounds as G.
6. Q4 · 3m **A: Oboe**. Oboe has G: the 7th (it falls by step).
7. Q4 · 3m **B: D♯4**. In the alto clef middle C is on the middle line, so X is D♯4.
8. Q4 · 3m **C: a secondary dominant (dominant 7th of II)**. X is D–F♯–A–C (V7/II): a secondary dominant (dominant 7th of II).
9. Q4 · 3m **B: V7/IV**. X is E–G♯–B–D: V7/IV, a secondary dominant (dominant 7th of IV). It is V7 of the key of IV, so its leading note (G♯) rises to the root of IV.
10. Q4 · 3m **C: with some freedom of time**. tempo rubato means "with some freedom of time".
11. Q4 · 4m **D: V7/VI**. Sounding notes at X: F♯, F♯, E, A♯: F♯–A♯–C♯–E, so V7/VI, a secondary dominant (dominant 7th of VI).
12. Q5 · 3m **B: B**. The horn in E♭ sounds a major 6th lower than written: written G♯ sounds as B.
13. Q5 · 3m **D: C**. The cor anglais sounds a perfect 5th lower than written: written G sounds as C.
14. Q5 · 3m **B: V7d/V**. Read the strings (they don't transpose): D, E, G♯, B: E–G♯–B–D, so V7d/V, a secondary dominant (dominant 7th of V).
15. Q5 · 3m **B: C**. The trumpet in D sounds a major 2nd higher than written: written B♭ sounds as C.
16. Q5 · 3m **C: V7b/V**. X is A–C♯–E–G: V7b/V, a secondary dominant (dominant 7th of V). It is V7 of the key of V, so its leading note (C♯) rises to the root of V.

17. Q5 · 3m **D: bow over the fingerboard (French)**. sur la touche means "bow over the fingerboard (French)".
18. Q5 · 3m **C: l'istesso tempo**. l'istesso tempo means "at the same speed (the beat stays the same)".
19. Q5 · 4m **D: F**. The clarinet in A sounds a minor 3rd lower than written: written A♭ sounds as F.